

Company: BlackRock

Job Profile: Software Engineer

Offer Type: Intern + PPO (Performance based)

Internship Stipend: 50k

CTC: 18 LPA

Location: Mumbai / Gurgaon / Bangalore

Process Date: PPT (20-08-2025) on Webex Platform (Pool Campus Placement Drive)

Placement Process:

Online Assessment -> 22-08-2025

Technical Round 1 -> 28-08-2025

Technical Round 2 -> 28-08-2025

HR -> 29-08-2025

1. Online Assessment Round [100 + candidates appeared]

During the placement process, one of the key eligibility criteria was maintaining a CGPA of **7.5 or above**. This benchmark served as the initial shortlisting factor and emphasized the importance of consistent academic performance. Apart from academics, the **resume played a vital role** in getting shortlisted. Having a properly formatted resume — preferably in [Jake's template](#) style — added a professional touch. What mattered more, however, was the **project section** of the resume. A strong resume required at least **one major project with unique features** that stood out from the rest, supported by a couple of **smaller personal projects** that showcased fundamental skills and hands-on experience. The project descriptions had to be written in **bullet points**, focusing on the specific features, outcomes, and technologies used. I also realized the importance of arranging projects in an order where the most impactful or “sellable” project was listed first, as it immediately captured the recruiter’s attention.

The **online assessment test** was conducted on the **eLitmus platform** and was fully proctored. Since this was **BlackRock's first visit to our campus**, there were no prior student experiences to rely on. To prepare effectively, I searched extensively on the web for insights into the test pattern and previous questions. Fortunately, the test format I came across online turned out to be largely consistent with the one that was actually conducted. The test duration was **1.5 hours**, and it was divided into **three major sections**: Aptitude, Programming, and SQL.

1. **Aptitude Section**

The aptitude section was divided into three subsections — **Quantitative Aptitude**, **Data Checking/Data Accuracy**, and **Logical Reasoning**.

- The **Quantitative Aptitude** questions revolved around standard topics such as arithmetic, percentages, ratios, and number systems, requiring both accuracy and speed.

- The **Data Checking/Data Accuracy** part was relatively straightforward and easy to solve. It primarily tested one's ability to identify inconsistencies or errors within datasets quickly.
- The **Logical Reasoning** subsection was interesting, involving questions on **pattern recognition, sequences, and puzzles**. The key here was to attempt as many questions as possible without spending too much time on a single problem. Proper **time management** was crucial in maximizing the score in this section.

Imp Links (Aptitude): [IndiaBix](#), [CodeHelp](#)

2. Programming Section

The programming part was unique compared to typical coding assessments, as it was split into **two subsections: Flowcharts and Pseudocodes**.

- In the **Flowchart subsection**, two flowcharts based on basic programming problems were provided. Each flowchart contained around **5–6 blanks** that we had to fill in. The questions were objective (MCQ-based), where the correct option had to be chosen for each blank. One of the flowcharts was related to a **string-matching algorithm**, while the other was relatively simple and could be solved with a clear understanding of flow control.
- The **Pseudocode subsection** contained **three MCQs** based on different algorithms and data structures. Two of them were focused on **Binary Trees/BSTs** (covering fundamental operations like insertion, deletion, traversal, and calculating depth). The third question was based on **AVL trees**, specifically testing knowledge of **rotateLeft and rotateRight operations (LL, LR, RL, RR)**. Since I had prepared these topics in advance, I was able to approach this section with confidence and accuracy.

3. SQL Section

The final section of the test comprised **20 MCQs on Oracle SQL**, which were mostly theoretical in nature. Compared to the earlier sections, this one was less time-consuming, as the **time allotted was more than sufficient** to go through all the questions. My preparation strategy for SQL involved practicing extensively on **LeetCode's SQL50 problems**, which helped me gain familiarity with various query patterns and functions. Although I had prepared using **MySQL**, I noticed that Oracle SQL had slight **syntactical differences**. In cases where I was unsure, I relied on logical reasoning and intuition to select the best possible answer.

Imp Links (Technical + SQL) : Topic wise, one-shot mcqs on GFG, [Leetcode50](#) (Sql)

Overall, the test was **balanced and well-structured**, checking a candidate's aptitude, algorithmic thinking, and database knowledge. My preparation strategy — focusing on **aptitude basics, binary/AVL trees, flowcharts, and SQL practice** — played a significant role in boosting my confidence and helping me attempt the test effectively.

Tip : When attempting the test, it is advisable to start with the section you are most confident in. Prioritizing technical MCQs and SQL questions can be beneficial, as securing accuracy in these areas helps maximize your score. If aptitude is not your strong suit, it is better to attempt that section at the end. This approach ensures that you focus first on questions where you are more likely to score, while managing time effectively across all sections.

BlackRock shortlisted candidates for four different roles based on the online assessment and the preferences we had selected. The roles were: **Aladdin Data** (5 shortlisted + 1 waitlisted), **Global Marketing** (3 shortlisted + 3 waitlisted), **Software Engineer** (15 shortlisted + 3 waitlisted), and **Software Engineer AWT** (3 shortlisted + 1 waitlisted), making a total of **34 candidates including waitlists**. I was shortlisted for the **Software Engineer role**, and I will be explaining my experience for this role further.

2. Technical Round 1 [18 candidates shortlisted]

My **first technical round** was conducted on the **Webex platform** and was scheduled at **12:00 PM**. Since it had to be attended from the **TPO office (on campus)**, I reached beforehand to ensure everything was set. Interestingly, my panel was moving faster than expected, and I was called in at around **11:30 AM**, slightly ahead of time. When I joined, there were already two panelists present in the session.

The interview began with the usual **greetings** and the request to switch on my camera. Soon after, the panel directly moved into **DSA-based questions**.

The **first problem** given to me was:

Sort n elements (assume 100) in **$O(n)$ time complexity**.

At first, I was taken aback because the sorting techniques I was confident with, such as **Merge Sort** and **Quick Sort**, typically work in **$O(n \log n)$** time. I mentioned this to the panel, but they clarified that they were looking specifically for an **$O(n)$** solution. After taking a few minutes to think, I demonstrated the sorting of **three elements in $O(n)$ time** using simple swapping. The interviewers seemed satisfied with my attempt, and they later explained that this problem could be efficiently solved using **Cyclic Sort**. I pointed out that this might increase the **space complexity**, but they assured me that it was acceptable. This exchange highlighted an important takeaway:

If you don't know the exact answer, keep communicating and explaining your thought process. Interviewers value your problem-solving approach as much as, or even more than, the final solution.

The **next question** was a classic **3-Sum Problem**. I began with the **brute-force approach**, then optimized it by explaining the **two-pointer technique**. While presenting, I carefully analyzed and conveyed the **time complexity** of each approach. The panel seemed pleased with my structured explanation and progression from brute force to optimal.

After this, I was asked about my **preferred programming language**. I responded that I primarily use **Java** for problem-solving and **Python** for development. One of the interviewers, who was an expert in Java, proceeded to ask me several **Java-related questions**. These covered concepts from **OOPs**, **threads**, and **exception handling**. Since I had prepared well in these areas, I was able to answer confidently, and the panel appeared satisfied with my responses.

Finally, the round concluded with a **puzzle question** — the famous **4 Litres Bucket Problem** ([reference link](#)). I asked for some time to think and gradually explained my thought process while attempting different possibilities. Although I got stuck briefly, I managed to work through the problem and eventually reached the solution. The interviewers appreciated my persistence and logical reasoning throughout.

Towards the end, I was given the opportunity to ask questions. I asked a couple of **role- and company-related questions**, which I believe is always a good practice as it demonstrates genuine interest in the company and the position.

3. Technical Round 2 [8 candidates shortlisted]

My **second technical round** lasted for about **40–50 minutes**. It began with a polite exchange of greetings and a brief **introduction from both sides**, which helped create a comfortable environment. Unlike the first round, this interview was **entirely based on my resume** ([resume link](#)) and my past experiences.

The interviewer first asked about the **SCOPE program at JPMC** that I had mentioned in my resume. I explained what the program was about, my **role in it**, and the key **learnings I gained** from the experience. She then shifted the focus to my **internship**, asking in-depth questions to understand my contributions and learnings better. During this discussion, she also asked whether I was comfortable working with **Git and GitHub**, which I confidently confirmed.

Next, she moved on to the **projects listed in my resume**. I described two of my projects in detail, focusing on their features, the technologies used, and the real-world problems they aimed to solve. Since one of my projects was from **Smart India Hackathon (SIH)**, where I had emerged as a **winner**, it particularly caught her attention. She found it inspiring and appreciated how the project had a **practical impact on real-world challenges**. Her feedback was very encouraging, as she praised my problem-solving mindset and the relevance of my work.

Towards the end, she asked if I had any questions for her. I took the opportunity to ask two:

1. How BlackRock has contributed to her **personal and professional growth**.
2. How BlackRock is adapting to **GenAI and AI/ML modules** in its work environment.

She responded warmly, providing **detailed and insightful answers** to both questions, which gave me a deeper understanding of BlackRock's culture and vision. The interview concluded on a positive note with final greetings.

A small but important takeaway from this round is to **always carry a smile and maintain a confident, positive demeanor** throughout the interaction — it goes a long way in leaving a lasting impression.

4. HR Round (Prank Round) [9 candidates shortlisted]

The next stage was supposed to be the **HR round**, but due to some unfortunate circumstances, BlackRock decided to terminate the process midway. However, our **TPO was in constant discussion with them**, trying to request and resolve the situation. As a result, instead of a formal HR interview, we had a **small, unofficial one-on-one interaction** with **Sikka Sir**, who offered valuable guidance and reassurance.

Later, the **final results** were announced by Sir himself in the **conference room**, where he also shared some inspiring words with us. In the end, **6 students were shortlisted for the Software Engineer role**, and **3 were placed on the waitlist**.

Important Links:

DSA -> Strivers A2Z sheet ([link](#))

DBMS -> Love Babbar ([link](#))

OS -> Love Babbar ([link](#))

CCN -> Just Basics (Chatgpt or gfg)

OOPs (Java) -> Kunal Kushwaha ([link](#))

Puzzle -> Gfg ([link](#))

Useful Tips:

- **Don't lose confidence** even if you face multiple rejections. I interviewed in 8 companies before BlackRock, and though I often felt demotivated, I eventually realized that **things fall into place at the right time**.
- Even if you feel others less deserving are getting placed, remember that **your journey is unique**. I had won multiple hackathons but wasn't placed initially — yet I ended up in a top MNC like BlackRock, which I never even dreamed of.
- **Stay confident and keep a smile** throughout your interview. It creates a positive impression and shows your enthusiasm.
- **Always interact with the interviewers**. Don't stay quiet — even if you don't know the exact answer, explain your **thought process**. Many times, they are more interested in how you approach the problem rather than just the final solution.
- **Practice explaining your projects clearly** in bullet points (features, technologies, and real-world impact). This not only shows clarity but also highlights your problem-solving ability.
- **Know your resume inside out**. HR and technical rounds can both heavily focus on what you've mentioned, so be prepared to discuss every detail confidently.
- **Prepare both technical and behavioral aspects**. While DSA and technical knowledge are crucial, soft skills, communication, and genuine interest in the company matter equally.
- **Ask questions at the end**. Always have 2–3 role- or company-related questions ready. This shows curiosity and genuine interest in the company.
- **Be consistent in preparation**. Whether it's aptitude, SQL, or programming, practicing regularly (LeetCode, mock tests, etc.) makes a big difference.
- **Network smartly**. Connect with seniors, peers, or professionals on LinkedIn to get insights into the process. Sometimes even small tips can give you an edge.
- And most importantly, **trust the process**. If one door closes, another one will open with an even better opportunity.

If you have any further doubts, feel free to **connect with me on [LinkedIn](#)** :)